

NxM Templates for SuperCDMS SNOLAB Run 4 — Ge Activation Data

K-line event selection · free-pretrigger two-exponential fits · 1x1 and NxM (PCA) templates

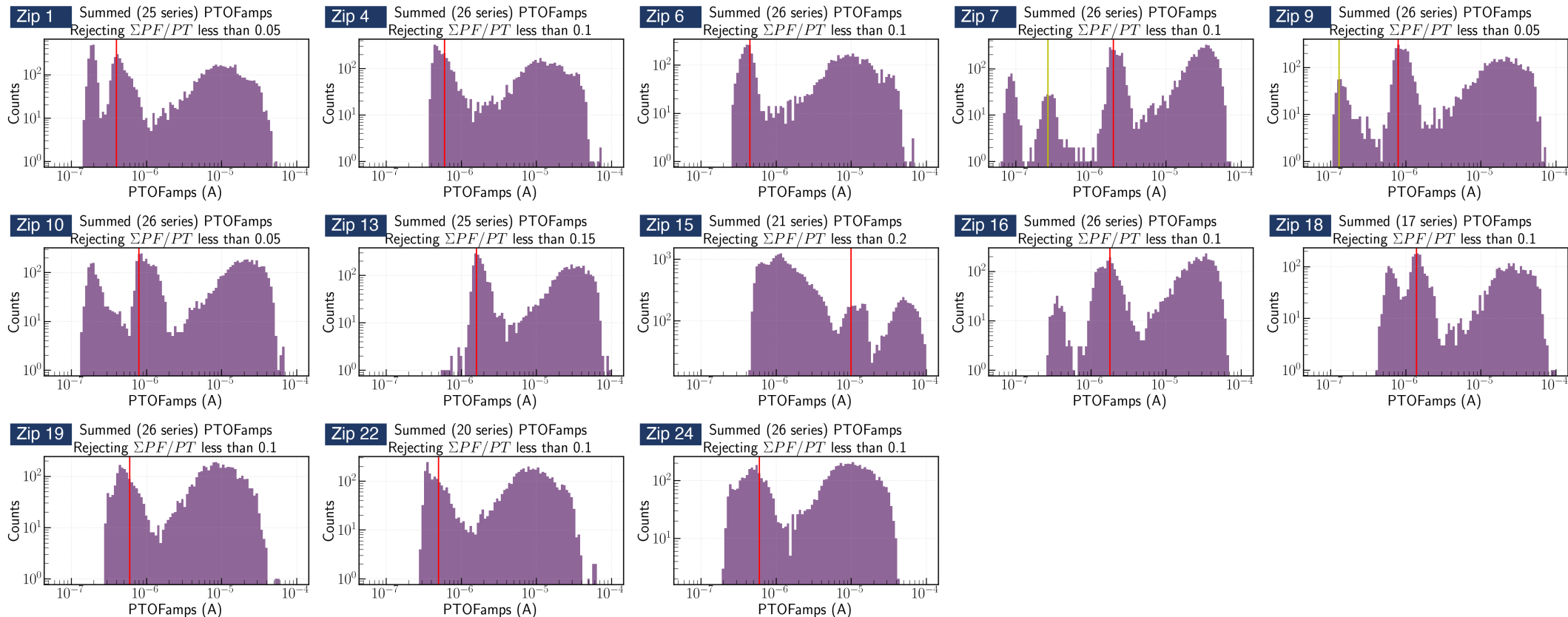
Zhiheng Li — July 2026

From the Ge-activation K-line to an event sample

Data: Ge Activation Data — Ops Shift 260612
Credit: Prof. Tarek Saab · SuperCDMS Confluence

Goal: one clean, minimally-biased pulse population per detector × channel

- Per detector, Prof. Saab's study marked the 10.37 keV K-line position in PTOFamps — the red line in each panel below
- Our event selection: a PTOFamps window bracketing the red line — position $\times/\div 1.35$, a rough, somewhat arbitrary eyeballed choice; deliberately minimal, no other cuts
- For every selected event: cache the fully unprocessed raw MIDAS traces of all channels + event metadata
- 13 detectors (zips) × 27–30 series → ~120 GB raw cache



All 13 detectors, PTOFamps spectra (Prof. Saab's study)

Per-trace algorithm: low-pass → fit → align

1. **Low-pass** — 100 kHz 4th-order Butterworth
2. **Normalize** — subtract the baseline, scale the trace to unit peak
3. **Fit** — two-exponential model, all 5 parameters free (including the pretrigger t_0):

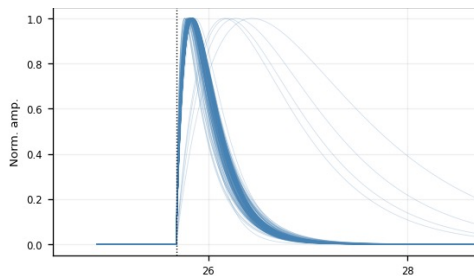
$$y(t) = A[e^{-(t-t_0)/\tau_{\text{fall}}} - e^{-(t-t_0)/\tau_{\text{rise}}}] + b$$

t_0 = pretrigger, free within 16050 ± 3000 samples (τ_{rise} , τ_{fall} : rise / fall time)

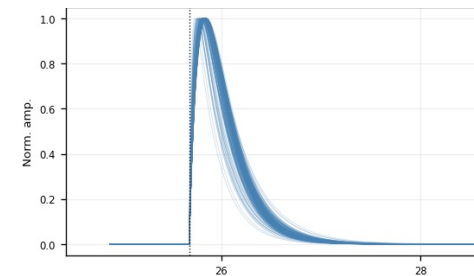
4. **Two quality numbers per trace** (recorded here, not cut yet):

- **fit_ok** — amplitude is positive, and the pulse rises faster than it falls
- **NRMSE** — RMS of the fit residual ÷ pulse peak (smaller = better fit)

5. **Align** — shift the measured trace by (fitted pretrigger - 16050)



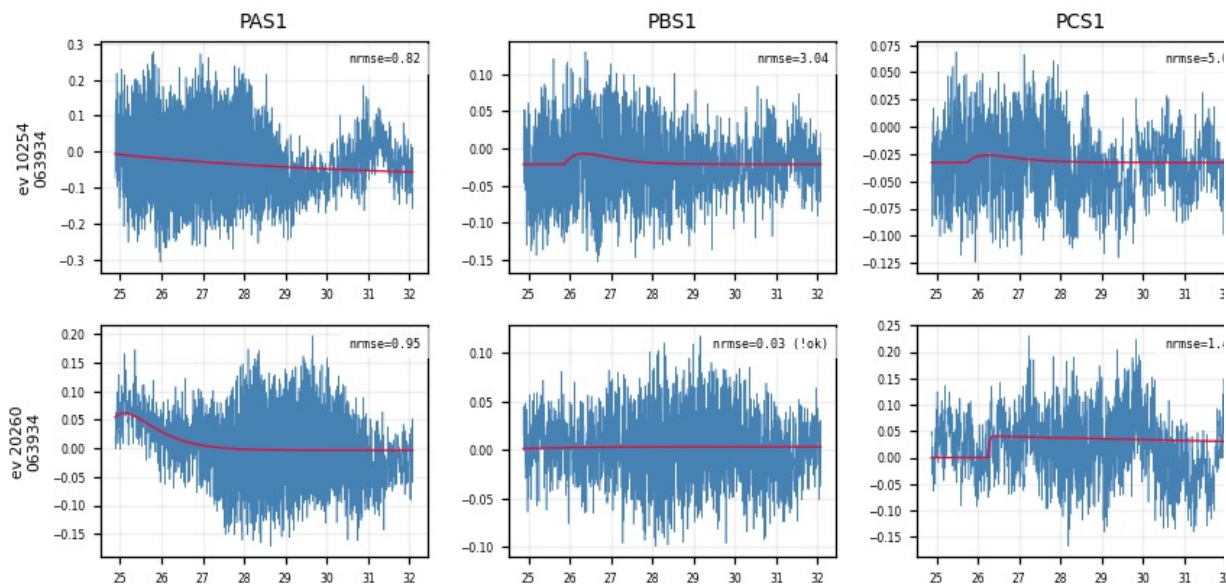
All fit_ok fitted curves (Z7 PBS1) — no cut



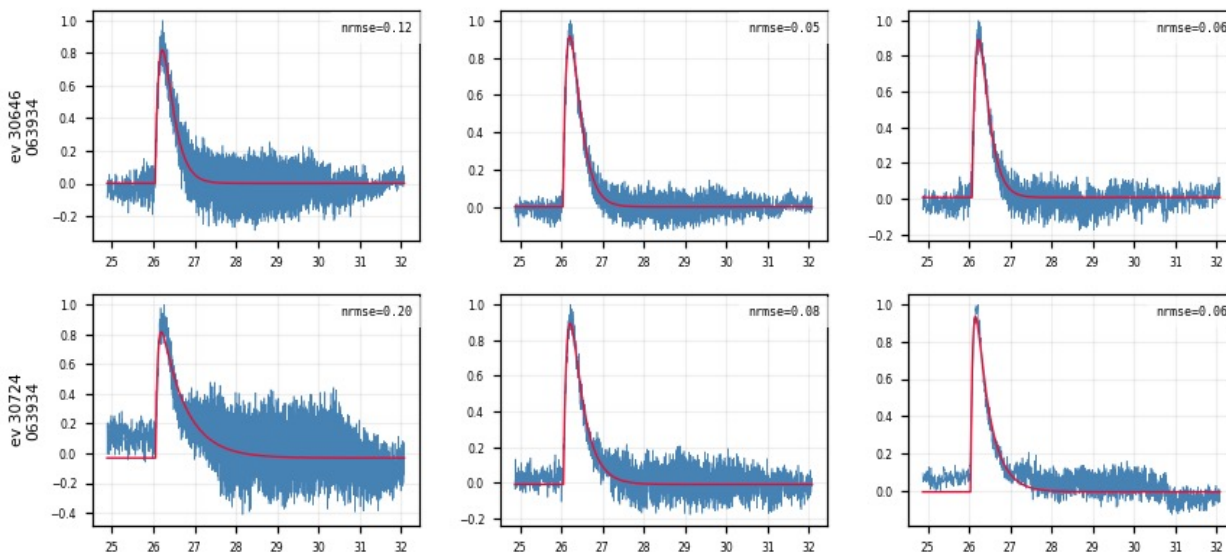
After $\text{NRMSE} \leq 0.4$ — one tight shape family

Fit quality at a glance — event × channel grids

- One row per event, one column per channel: low-passed trace (blue) vs 2-exp fit (red), NRMSE stamped per panel
- The same event fits consistently across channels; a noise trigger fails in all channels at once



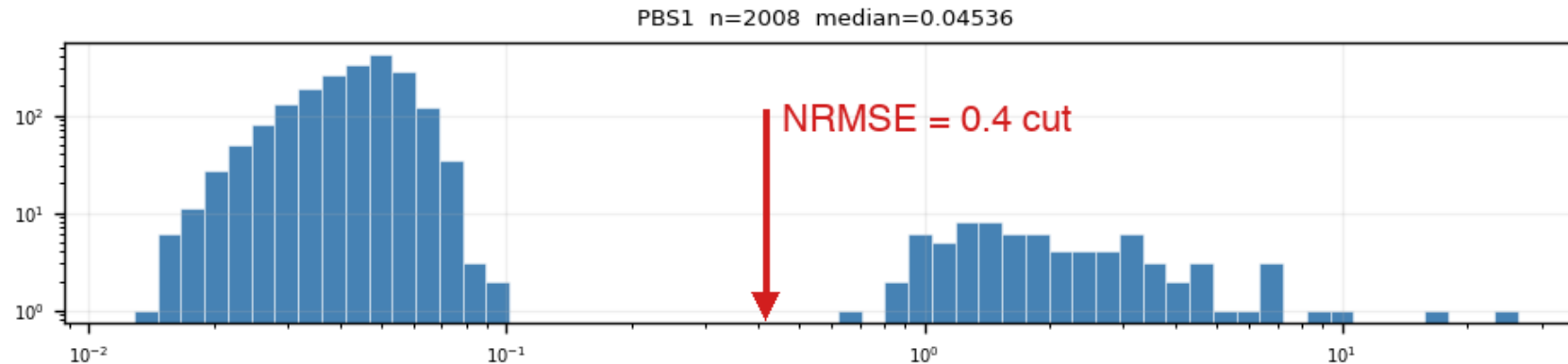
Noise triggers: the fit fails in every channel at once



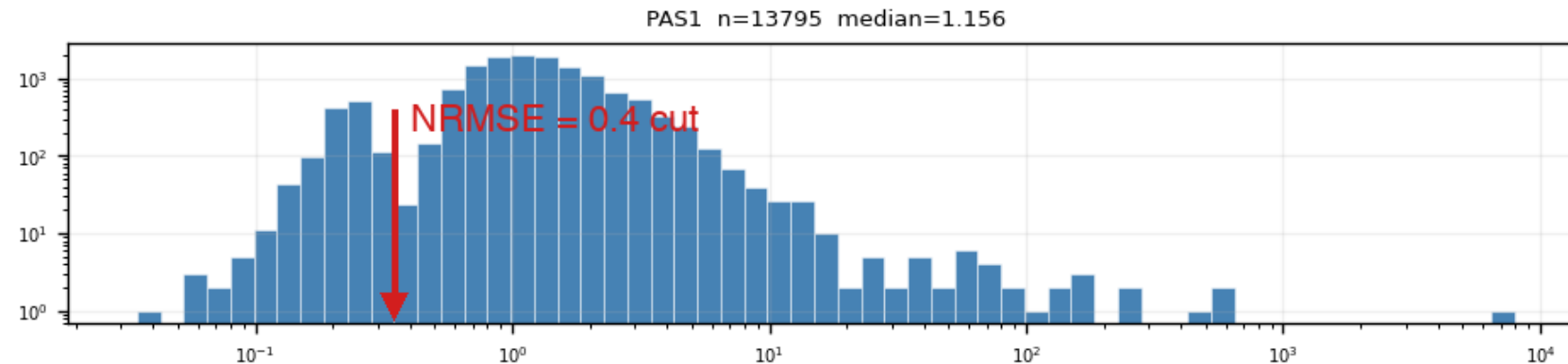
K-line events: consistent good fits across channels

Quality cut 1: $\text{NRMSE} \leq 0.4$ — where the number comes from

- NRMSE of fit_ok events is bimodal: good fits (median ≈ 0.05 – 0.1) vs noise triggers (≈ 1 – 2), valley at ≈ 0.4 – 0.5
- The cut sits in the valley — it is read off the distribution, not tuned on the templates
- Noisy detectors (Z1, Z4, Z6, Z18, Z19, Z22, Z24): the PTOF window admits a noise-dominated mixture — this cut is what extracts the real-pulse population



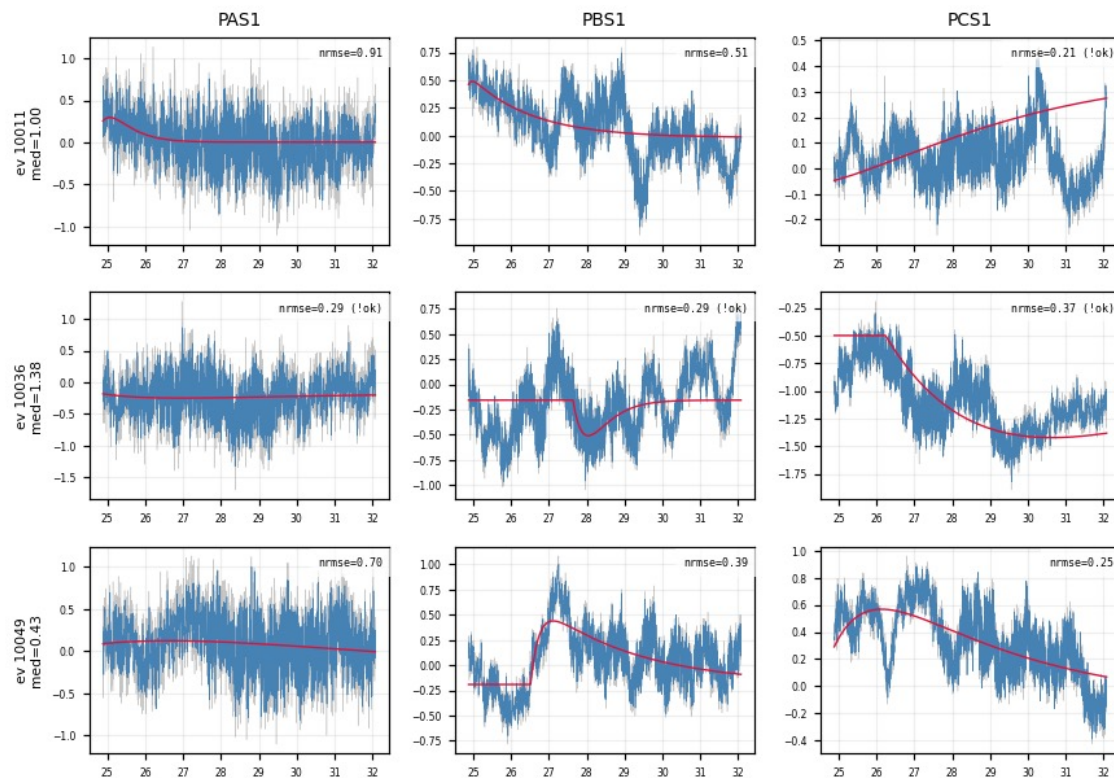
Z7 PBS1 (quiet): two clean populations, log-log axes



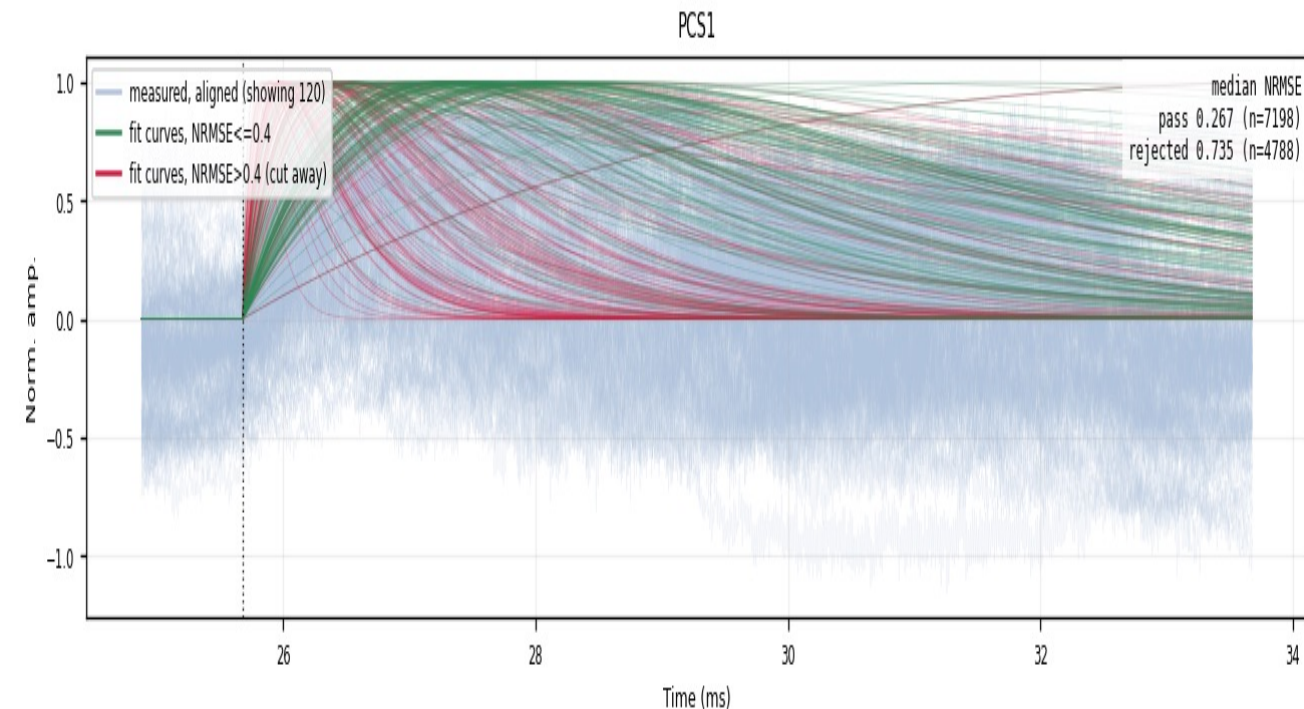
Z22 PAS1 (noisy): noise population dominates — the window alone is not enough

The rejected population is noise — verified in the raw traces

- Event grids of NRMSE-rejected events (median NRMSE > 0.4 across channels): the raw traces show no pulse — the cut removes noise triggers, not physics



Z22: NRMSE-rejected events — raw traces are noise



— passes the cut (kept)

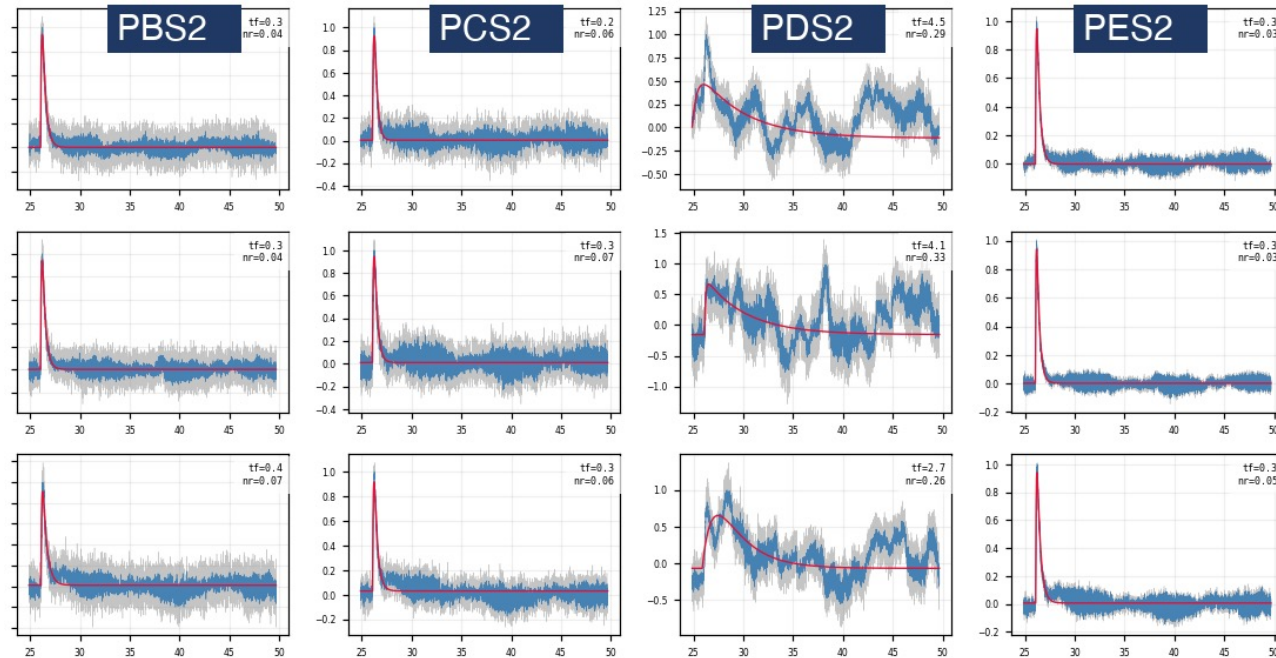
faint blue = measured traces

— cut away = rejected

Z22 PCS1: 7198 kept / 4788 cut (~40%)

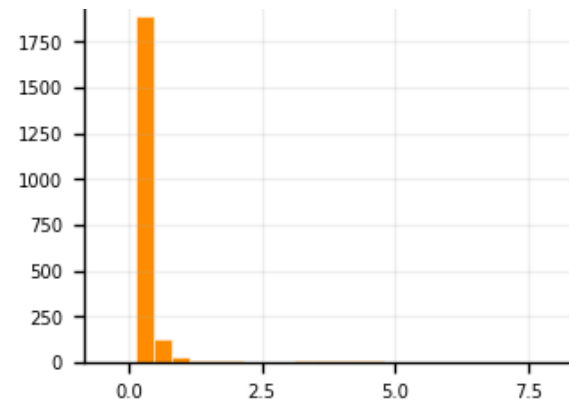
Follow-up 1 — the slow-fall tail is a one-channel artifact

- The post-cut fan still shows slow-fall tails → sample them: $\text{NRMSE} \leq 0.4$ AND $\tau_{\text{fall}} > 1.5$ ms, 10 random events, raw vs fit drawn in all 12 channels
- The sampled events are real pulses → kept. Their extreme fall times trace to one channel: only PDS2 swings (τ_{fall} median 0.51 ms vs ≈ 0.25 ms elsewhere) — a low-frequency disturbance
- Conclusion: no τ_{fall} cut — slow-fall events passing NRMSE stay in; the extreme tail is a one-channel artifact, not physics

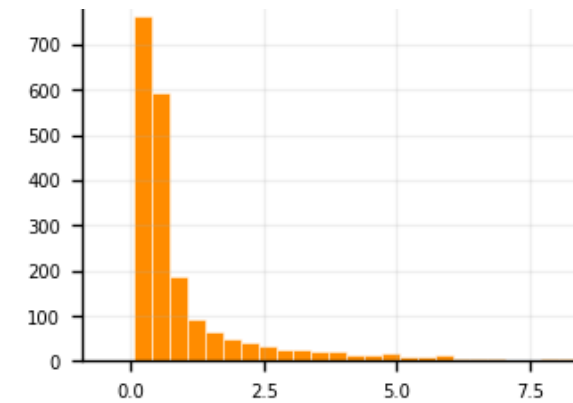


Z7, 3 sampled slow-fall events: normal in PBS2/PCS2/PES2, swings only in PDS2

Fitted τ_{fall} distribution, same 0–7 ms axis:



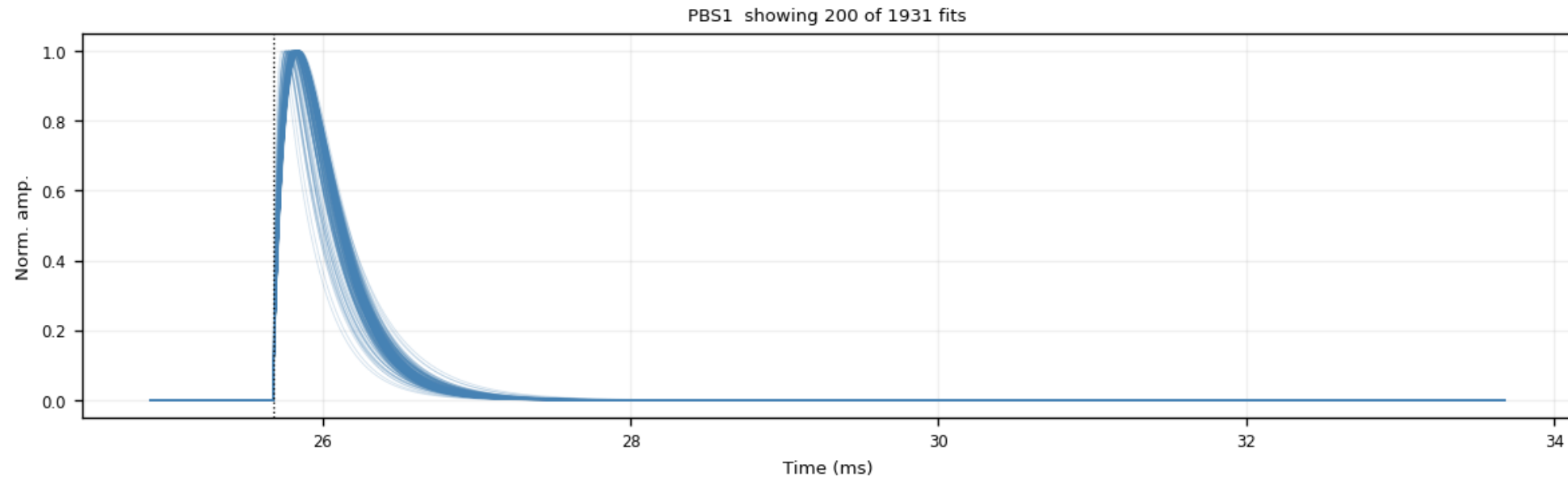
PAS1 — normal channel: narrow (median 0.25 ms)



PDS2 — bad channel: broad tail (median 0.51 ms)

Template family 1 — analytic 2-exp, NRMSE-weighted (1x1)

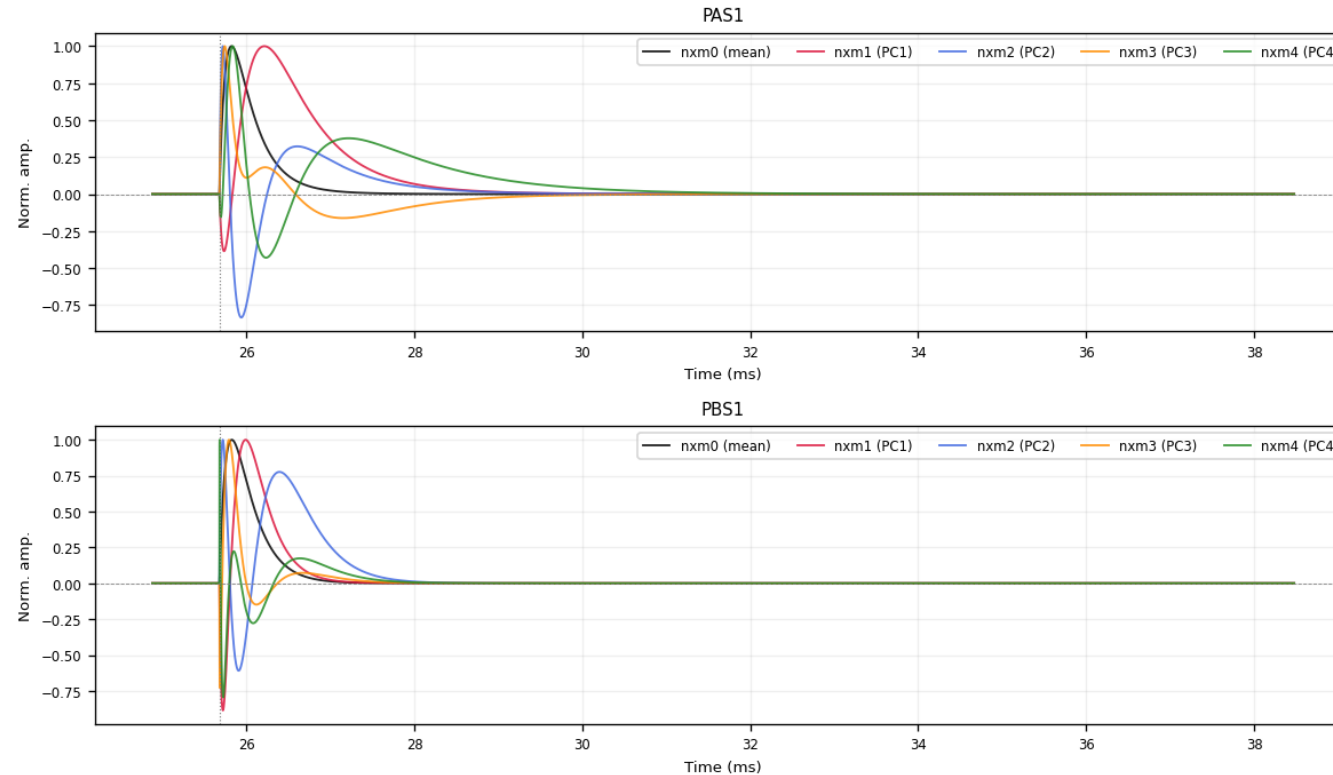
- NRMSE-weighted mean of the fit_ok 2-exp curves
- Smooth & noise-free by construction
- ROOT TH1D, peak-normalized (+ summed PT / PS1 / PS2)



Z7 PBS1, fitted curves after $\text{NRMSE} \leq 0.4$ and $\tau_{\text{rise}} \leq 0.3$ ms — the NRMSE-weighted mean of this family is the 1x1 template

Template family 2 — NxM PCA templates

- Per-channel PCA over the clean fitted curves ($\text{fit_ok} + \text{NRMSE} \leq 0.4 + \tau_{\text{rise}} \leq 0.3 \text{ ms}$)
- nxm0 = mean shape; nxm1 – 4 = principal components; $\text{real pulse} = \sum_i \text{amp}_i \cdot \text{nxm}_i$
- $\text{PC1} + \text{PC2} \approx 96\text{--}98\%$ of the shape variance; delivered peak-normalized



Z7 PAS1 / PBS1: nxm0 (mean) + nxm1 – 4 (PCs) — the oscillating components encode rise/fall-time variation

Delivered — and what remains

- Two template families built for all 13 detectors: 1x1 (2-exp weighted) + NxM PCA
- Delivered in the official cdmsbats PulseTemplates format
- Cuts read off the data, verified in raw traces: $\text{NRMSE} \leq 0.4$, $\tau_{\text{rise}} \leq 0.3 \text{ ms}$